IELTS ACADEMIC · RESTRICTED STAFF MATERIAL

IELTS Academic Set 27

PRIVATE STAFF answer key and Listening transcript

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Answer keys and Listening transcripts are restricted to staff.

Listening

Question	Answer	Accepted variants
1	Canada	
2	scarf	
3	1.8	
4	75	seventy-five
5	Lane	
6	Economy	
7	C	
8	A	
9	B	
10	C	
11	B	
12	F	
13	A	
14	H	
15	D	
16	G	
17	red	
18	tide board	
19	handrail	the handrail

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Question	Answer	Accepted variants
20	adult supervision	supervision
21	F	
22	C	
23	B	
24	D	
25	A	
26	B	
27	A	
28	C	
29	B	
30	C	
31	dust	
32	albedo	
33	meltwater	
34	granules	
35	ice	
36	contamination	
37	A	
38	B	
39	C	
40	A	

Listening transcript

Part 1 - Everyday social dialogue: an international parcel enquiry at an Auckland post counter

Callum Webb	Good morning. Are you sending an international parcel today, or do you first need advice about the declaration?
Moana Reed	Both, please. The parcel is for my cousin in Vancouver. I completed part of the online form last night, but I stopped when it asked about the contents and value.
Callum Webb	I will make a new declaration. The destination is Canada, not the United States address saved in your account. Is that right?
Moana Reed	Yes, Canada. The American address belongs to another relative. This parcel is going to Vancouver, and the postcode on the label is the Canadian one.

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Callum Webb	Now describe the main item in ordinary language. The form does not need a gift message. You mentioned clothing online; can we be more precise?
Moana Reed	It is a wool scarf. I nearly wrote just gift, but the help note said to name the item, so wool scarf would be accurate.
Callum Webb	The scale shows one point eight kilograms. That replaces your estimate of two and a half, which included a bag you are keeping.
Moana Reed	Please record one point eight kilograms, then. The scarf cost sixty dollars and the puzzle was fifteen, so the total declared value is seventy-five New Zealand dollars.
Callum Webb	I also need the sender address. The screen currently says fourteen Aroha Road, but the label on your box says fourteen Aroha Lane. Which is current?
Moana Reed	Aroha Lane is correct. Road was my old address. The house number remains fourteen, which is probably why I missed the error.
Callum Webb	Economy Track includes tracking and takes eight to twelve working days. Priority is faster but normally requires a weekday signature.
Moana Reed	My cousin works away from home on weekdays, so the signature could cause difficulty. Economy Track is fine; I care more about being able to follow the parcel than about the shortest time.
Callum Webb	Before payment, let us check every item against the current destination list. You have the scarf, a small wooden puzzle, a watercolour set and this jar of honey. The list on my screen says the honey cannot be accepted in this parcel.
Moana Reed	Then I will take the honey out. I have posted it within New Zealand before, so I assumed it would be acceptable overseas as well.
Callum Webb	Domestic acceptance does not prove international acceptance. The sender must confirm each item is permitted, although counter staff can help.
Moana Reed	Understood. What about the wooden puzzle? It is painted and new, not an antique, and it is still in the shop packaging.
Callum Webb	The puzzle and watercolours are acceptable today. Keep the descriptions specific so the declaration matches the contents.
Moana Reed	Should I handwrite another address label? My writing is clear, but there is not much room beside the return address.
Callum Webb	Do not add another handwritten label. The counter printer produces the final address and customs labels together. I will place them on the largest face of the box and leave the seams clear.
Moana Reed	So the completed declaration says Canada, wool scarf, one point eight kilograms, seventy-five dollars and fourteen Aroha Lane. The honey is removed, and I have chosen Economy Track.
Callum Webb	Exactly. Confirm the declaration, and I will print the labels today. Keep the tracking receipt, but remember that the sender remains responsible for an accurate contents statement.

Part 2 - Everyday social monologue: visitor orientation at a fictional ocean pool in Sydney

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Zoe Bartlett	Welcome to Harbour Shelf Ocean Pool. I am Zoe, the duty lifeguard. Before anyone changes or enters the water, I will describe the site plan, today's tide arrangements and the route we use when one area closes.
Zoe Bartlett	You are at the street entrance on the south edge, with north at the top. Reception is directly ahead in the centre.
Zoe Bartlett	Look at the plan. From the entrance, turn right before reception and follow the path to the eastern wall. The changing room is the long public room immediately south of the smaller staff store.
Zoe Bartlett	Return to reception and take the path on your left. Pass the ticket office nearest reception, then turn slightly north. The first-aid room is below the centre of the shallow end. Do not continue to the far western boundary.
Zoe Bartlett	From first aid, continue north-west along the boundary. The accessible ramp is directly below the shallow end, at the far western edge. Nearby steps are shorter, but only the ramp has a handrail and gradual slope.
Zoe Bartlett	The main lap lanes occupy the centre of the pool. The tide gate is beyond their northern end, just outside the upper-right corner of the lane area. Staff operate it; swimmers must never try to move it, even when the water appears calm.
Zoe Bartlett	Now look south-east of reception. Two possible places sit near the street entrance. The family deck is the more central one, with benches and a clear view of the shallow area. The other place, farther east near the boundary, is only a delivery bay.
Zoe Bartlett	Finally, the equipment racks are south-west of reception, closer to the street entrance than the first-aid room. Personal property belongs in lockers; the racks are for kickboards and pool wheelchairs.
Zoe Bartlett	You now have the main layout. We will move on to the safety details shown on the same plan.
Zoe Bartlett	This pool is affected by coastal conditions. Staff check the local forecast and the tide board throughout the day. A high tide does not close the pool automatically, but waves crossing the outer wall may change the decision.
Zoe Bartlett	If a section closes, staff raise a red flag beside reception. The electronic sign repeats the message, but the flag is the quickest answer if you are already on the deck. A yellow flag means extra caution, not closure.
Zoe Bartlett	Before walking to the northern path, read the tide board. It displays the staff inspection time as well as the expected tide. A phone forecast may be useful before travelling, but the tide board gives the decision for this facility.
Zoe Bartlett	At the accessible ramp, enter facing forward and use the handrail. The painted edge is a visual guide; it is not something to grip. If you need the pool wheelchair, ask at reception rather than moving one from the equipment rack yourself.
Zoe Bartlett	Children may watch from the family deck, but anyone entering the pool outside a coached lesson needs adult supervision. Lifeguards oversee the entire facility, so families must keep that supervision in place throughout the visit.
Zoe Bartlett	The lap lanes run north to south. Keep the ramp landing clear, and walk around the wide southern end to reach the far side.

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Zoe Bartlett	If the tide gate closes during your visit, leave the northern deck by the signed route west of the lap lanes. Do not return through the gate area to collect belongings. Staff will recover anything left there when conditions allow.
Zoe Bartlett	After swimming, shower briefly, return borrowed equipment to the racks south-west of reception and use the changing room on the eastern wall. Please report any damaged handrail or loose surface immediately instead of assuming another visitor has already done so.
Zoe Bartlett	To recap: a red flag shows closure, read the tide board, use the ramp handrail, and remember that children require adult supervision. We will now walk the safe southern route.

Part 3 - Educational discussion: two trainee reporters verify a fictional breaking-news image in Toronto

Simone Baptiste	This photograph reached our queue at eight fifteen. Its caption claims flooding outside a Toronto station this morning, but we must verify origin, time and location.
Declan Shore	It shows water across a road, a red bus and a shop with a blue awning. Those details do not prove the caption. Let us assign each check.
Simone Baptiste	First, we need the earliest known online appearance. I will run a reverse-image search. If an older copy exists, the current post may be recycling an image from another event.
Declan Shore	For the camera time, I will inspect the image metadata. A timestamp can be altered or stripped, so it is a clue rather than proof.
Simone Baptiste	The sky in the photograph is bright, yet the caption says heavy rain was falling at seven. We can compare that visual clue with a weather archive for the claimed place and hour.
Declan Shore	For location, the shop sign is blurred, but the mural and the shape of the junction are distinctive. A street map with recent imagery should let us compare those fixed landmarks.
Simone Baptiste	I will contact the original uploader, ask what they saw and request the uncompressed file. We can also confirm permission.
Declan Shore	So: reverse search for earliest appearance, metadata for time, weather archive for conditions, street map for landmarks, and the uploader for first-hand context.
Simone Baptiste	I have the reverse search result. The same photograph appeared eighteen months ago on a community blog in Halifax. It was cropped differently, but the bus, awning and water pattern are identical.
Declan Shore	Then it is not a new Toronto image. A current account has attached a fresh caption to an old photograph.
Simone Baptiste	The metadata contains a creation date matching that older post, not today. However, the location field is empty. That supports the age finding but gives us no coordinates.
Declan Shore	Missing coordinates do not prove manipulation. Devices or platforms may omit them. The file does not establish location; that is all we can conclude.
Simone Baptiste	The weather archive makes the Toronto caption even less likely. The claimed hour was dry and overcast, whereas the image has strong sunlight and deep shadows. Still, weather alone cannot identify Halifax.

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Declan Shore	I compared the mural with street imagery. It matches a junction near Halifax Harbour, including the unusual triangular window above the shop. The red vehicle is a tour bus, not a Toronto transit bus as I first assumed.
Simone Baptiste	The correction matters. Colour suggested public transport, but the visible company logo and route context are stronger evidence.
Declan Shore	The uploader has replied. She took the original during a coastal storm in Halifax and posted it to the community blog. She did not upload today's copy and did not give the current account permission.
Simone Baptiste	We now have converging evidence: an older publication, an old creation date, Halifax landmarks and the photographer's account. The Toronto caption is false, although the underlying scene itself was real.
Declan Shore	Should we publish a correction immediately? The misleading post has only a small audience, and repeating the image might spread it further.
Simone Baptiste	We should hold the image, preserve our evidence and alert the news editor. The editor can choose a correction, verification note or no article.
Declan Shore	We should not contact the transit authority because we know the scene is elsewhere. A source call should test a live uncertainty.
Simone Baptiste	I will save screenshots with dates and URLs, plus the original file supplied by the photographer. I will record which search produced each result and when we contacted the uploader. A written trail lets another reporter reproduce our conclusion rather than trusting our memory.
Declan Shore	Our wording should separate findings from limits. The image predates today and depicts Halifax, but we cannot infer who wrote the caption or their motive.
Simone Baptiste	Exactly. The strongest result is not simply fake image. It is a genuine older photograph presented with a false current location and time. That description is both more precise and easier to defend.
Declan Shore	I will update the log: do not publish as breaking news, refer the decision to the editor, retain the evidence and avoid claims about motive. We should also note that our conclusion depends on several independent checks, not one technical clue.

Part 4 - Academic monologue: cryoconite holes in a polar-science lecture at a university in Otago

Lecturer	Today we will examine cryoconite holes, small melt features found on glacier surfaces. Their name refers to dark material on ice, but the holes are not merely dirty depressions. They connect physical melting, microbial activity and the movement of water across a glacier.
Lecturer	Cryoconite begins with fine mineral dust and organic particles deposited by wind, meltwater or nearby exposed ground. The material is visibly darker than clean snow or ice, and researchers compare the two surfaces carefully.
Lecturer	The relevant property is albedo, the proportion of incoming radiation a surface reflects. Clean bright ice has relatively high albedo, while a dark patch has lower albedo. We will return later to the physical consequence of that contrast.
Lecturer	Dark particles can settle into a shallow cavity while remaining exposed to light from above. Meltwater collects around them, and the wet sediment creates a small habitat whose depth and outline can change during the season.

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Lecturer	The sediment is not biologically inert. Bacteria, algae and other microorganisms live among the grains. Sticky substances produced by microbes help bind fine particles into granules; the resulting structure is compact rather than a completely loose layer of dust.
Lecturer	Those granules provide surfaces, nutrients and small protected spaces. Photosynthetic organisms can add organic carbon, while other microbes consume or transform material. The community is shaped by both mineral particles and biological interactions.
Lecturer	Conditions differ among glaciers. On temperate ice, water may move through open surface channels. In very cold polar settings, a lid of ice can form above the liquid water for part of the season.
Lecturer	Researchers record the presence of that lid together with diameter, depth, sediment mass, light and temperature. These measurements allow apparently similar holes to be compared without assuming that they function in the same way.
Lecturer	Water routes also matter. Moving meltwater can carry cells, dissolved nutrients and fine sediment. A channel may add or remove material quickly, whereas a hole without a visible channel may retain a more local chemical signal.
Lecturer	Sampling creates a further difficulty because removing water or sediment changes the structure being measured. A scoop can mix layers, disturb granules and carry surrounding ice into the material collected for analysis.
Lecturer	That final problem is contamination. Good field practice records the location and physical form before collection, then uses clean tools. Care reduces introduced material, although natural differences between holes still remain.
Lecturer	We can now explain why the darker material may deepen the ice beneath it. Its lower albedo means that it absorbs more incoming energy than bright ice, so local melting can proceed more quickly.
Lecturer	This mechanism does not mean that every dark patch develops at the same rate. Sediment thickness, shade, weather and drainage all modify the response, so appearance alone is not enough to predict final depth. A thin patch may disperse, while a sheltered deposit can persist through several measurement visits.
Lecturer	The ice lid also needs careful interpretation. It can make a hole relatively closed for a period, but the system is not permanently sealed. Light can pass through ice, and later melting can reopen a connection.
Lecturer	Consequently, a covered hole may still change biologically and chemically. Researchers note when the lid forms, whether gases or water can move, and when seasonal drainage reconnects the feature to the wider glacier surface. Temperature records help distinguish a temporary cover from a longer winter condition.
Lecturer	Replicate samples are valuable because they represent spatial variation better than one hole. Several samples from a defined area reveal whether a result is common or simply a feature of one unusual cavity.
Lecturer	Repeating those samples through the melt season adds a time dimension. It can show whether changes in microbes, water chemistry or depth are stable patterns or brief responses to recent conditions. Consistent collection intervals make comparisons across visits easier to interpret. Repeated visits also show whether different areas follow comparable seasonal trajectories.

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Lecturer	The strongest study design therefore combines biological sampling with physical and hydrological observations. Microbial groups and pigments are interpreted alongside depth, reflectance, water routes, temperature and the timing of lid formation.
Lecturer	Integration does not remove uncertainty. A relationship between darker sediment and deeper holes is consistent with enhanced absorption, but exposure time, weather and water movement can also affect depth. Mechanisms must be tested rather than assumed. Field notes should therefore record exceptions as carefully as the expected pattern.
Lecturer	To summarise, mineral dust begins the feature, microbes organize particles into granules, and local surface properties influence melting. Careful records, clean collection, repeated sampling and linked biological, physical and water measurements turn a small dark cavity into a useful scientific system.

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Reading

Question	Answer	Accepted variants
1	iv	
2	i	
3	vii	
4	iii	
5	ix	
6	ii	
7	vi	
8	fixed blueprint	
9	sticks	
10	defence	
11	communal thatch	thatch
12	nesting material	
13	individual marks	marks
14	environmental feedback	feedback
15	FALSE	
16	FALSE	
17	TRUE	
18	TRUE	
19	FALSE	
20	TRUE	
21	A	
22	B	
23	B	
24	A	
25	C	
26	B	
27	NO	
28	YES	

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Question	Answer	Accepted variants
29	YES	
30	NOT GIVEN	
31	YES	
32	NOT GIVEN	
33	NO	
34	C	
35	A	
36	D	
37	B	
38	B	
39	D	
40	A	

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